SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 147

WHEREAS, The Senate of the State of Texas is pleased to recognize Greater Saint James Temple African Methodist Episcopal Church on the grand occasion of its 150th anniversary; and

WHEREAS, Under the leadership of its first pastor, Reverend J. R. Carson, Saint James AME Church was organized on May 1, 1876; the church's first location in downtown Dallas welcomed worshippers until 1919, when the new building, designed by architect William Sidney Pittman, opened on Good and Latimer Streets; the congregation would call this historic building home for more than six decades; and

WHEREAS, Over the years, the church body has remained resilient and devoted through many leadership changes as well as multiple renovations, relocations, and necessary updates, and in 1999, the church adopted the name Greater Saint James Temple AME Church; and

WHEREAS, This cherished institution has served as a cornerstone of worship, guidance, and fellowship for generations of members; the enduring commitment of its pastors to minister to the social, spiritual, and physical well-being of all continues today through community outreach programs and compassionate support for the less fortunate; and

WHEREAS, The church's 150th anniversary is indeed a fitting opportunity to reflect on its rich history and to pay tribute to those whose faith and dedication have shaped its legacy of service; the celebration will begin May 1, 2026, and culminate with a special worship service on May 3 under Bishop Ronnie E. Brailsford Sr., presiding prelate of the 10th AME Episcopal District; now, therefore, be it

PROCLAIMED, That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby commend the leaders and members of Greater Saint James Temple African Methodist Episcopal Church on reaching this significant milestone; and, be it further

PROCLAIMED, That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for the church in honor of this special occasion.

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Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

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Secretary of the Senate